

Proposal-Writing Checklist

Winning That Government Contracting Award · Session 4 · Keep this next to your keyboard

The formula for every key claim: feature → quantified benefit → proof → the customer by name.

BEFORE YOU WRITE

- ☐ Compliance matrix built: every "shall" has a row
- ☐ Each row mapped to its Section L location and Section M factor
- ☐ 3 or 4 win themes chosen, from your capture plan
- ☐ Discriminators you can prove, not just claim
- ☐ Know the evaluation basis: best value or LPTA

CORRECT

- ☐ Staffing and schedule actually work
- ☐ Price meets the wage determination, if there is one
- ☐ Numbers match across volumes
- ☐ Past performance is recent and relevant
- ☐ No claim you can't back up

CUT THESE

World-class, state-of-the-art	A number
We believe, we will strive	Our team will
We understand your needs	Show it in the approach
We are pleased to submit	Start with their goal

COMPLIANT

- ☐ Every requirement answered, in the RFP's order
- ☐ Page limits, font, margins exactly as Section L says
- ☐ Every attachment and form filled and returned
- ☐ Amendments acknowledged
- ☐ Due date, time and time zone on your calendar twice

COMPELLING

- ☐ Every feature passes the "so what?" test
- ☐ Customer's name about 2:1 over yours
- ☐ Their words: if they say "plan," you say plan
- ☐ Key point first in every paragraph
- ☐ Original graphics, numbered, with a theme in each caption

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- ☐ Two or three outside readers reviewed it (red team)
- ☐ Checked against the compliance matrix, row by row
- ☐ One last read of Section L
- ☐ Submitted early, with a confirmation saved

Free one-on-one help with capture, compliance matrices and proposal reviews: Brandon Mason, Maryland SBDC, bwmason@umd.edu · mdsbdc.ecenterdirect.com/signup

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